

IELTS Writing: Two-Part Question Pack

Book 16 · Stop losing Task Response on double questions

Stratum IELTS · stratumielts.com

Edition 2026 · Original content

Part of the Stratum IELTS Writing Guide Series

Who this book is for

The prompt has **two questions**.

You write a long answer to the first... and one weak sentence for the second.

Task Response drops hard — a classic YouTube/examiner warning.

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1. How to spot two-part questions

Common shapes:

- *Why...? Is this positive or negative?*
- *What are the causes...? What effects...?*
- *What problems...? What solutions...?* (also problem/solution type)
- *Do advantages outweigh disadvantages?* (needs both sides + judgement)

Rule: if there are two tasks, both must be clearly answered in the essay body.

Underline both tasks before writing.

2. Balanced structure options

Option A — one body each (most common)

- Intro (paraphrase + preview both answers)
- Body 1 = Question 1
- Body 2 = Question 2
- Conclusion (summarise both)

Option B — split inside bodies (only if tightly linked)

Use carefully. Beginners should prefer Option A.

Timing check (40 min)

Plan 5 → Body1 12 → Body2 12 → Intro/Conclusion 6 → Edit 5
(or write intro first if you prefer; keep bodies equal)

Balance test: if Body 1 is 180 words and Body 2 is 40, rebuild.

3. Planning template (2 minutes)

Q1 task: _____

Q1 idea + example: _____

Q2 task: _____

Q2 idea + example: _____

Intro preview covers both? Yes / No

If either line is empty, do not start the essay.

4. Worked examples

Example 1

Prompt: In some countries, young people are moving from rural areas to big cities. Why is this happening? Is it a positive or negative development?

Body 1 (Why): jobs, universities, lifestyle opportunities

Example: graduate moves for internship market

Body 2 (Positive/negative): mixed but mostly positive for individuals; pressure on cities / rural decline

Judgement: positive for many young people, with social costs that need policy support

Intro preview: *This essay explains the main reasons for this migration and argues that it is largely positive for individuals despite urban pressures.*

Example 2

Prompt: Many people today work longer hours. Why? What effects does this have on individuals and families?

Body 1 (Why): job competition, digital "always on", living costs

Body 2 (Effects): stress/health issues; less family time

Keep both developed equally.

Example 3

Prompt: Children spend more time on screens. Why has this happened? What can be done about it?

Body 1: cheap entertainment + online homework/social life

Body 2: parental limits, school digital-literacy rules, offline activities funding

5. Practice set

For each: write a 3-minute plan with equal Q1/Q2 bullets, then one full timed essay.

1. Why do people prefer online shopping? Is this positive or negative for society?
2. Why is fast food popular? What effects does it have on health?
3. Why are some languages dying out? What can governments do?
4. Why do people use private cars instead of public transport? How can this change?
5. Why is academic pressure increasing? Is this a positive or negative trend?

After writing, ask: *Did I answer both parts with similar depth?*

Check at <https://stratumielts.com>.

6. Next step

- Structure basics → **Book 1**
- Blank mind on either part → **Book 7**
- Education two-part prompts → **Book 15**
- Plateau after fixing coverage → **Book 6**

Pocket rule: two questions → two developed answers.

Published by **Stratum IELTS** · stratumielts.com · Edition 2026

End of Book 16 — Two-Part Question Pack